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Samsung Galaxy S20 FE 5G

Style meets substance

Unlike the S20 FE 4G that came with an Exynos 990 SoC, the new 5G variant of the phone uses Qualcomm's Snapdragon 865 chipset. This not only makes the new phone 5G ready but also a more powerful device.

DESIGN AND DISPLAY

Samsung's decision to use plastic instead of glass as the phone's core material puts the Galaxy S20 FE 5G at an obvious disadvantage. The S20 FE 5G has just about the right amount of heft to feel solid when you hold it in your hand, and the matte finish back of the phone is quite a sight to behold.

The display is a 6.5-inch Full HD+ Super AMOLED panel capable of reaching a high refresh rate of 120 Hz. While we would have preferred support for WQHD+ resolution, it'll be fair to say we're happy with the fact that at least there's support for a fast refresh rate here as it definitely improves the overall experience of using the device. As for the other aspects of the performance of the display, we found the panel to get plenty bright during the day and also offer good viewing angles.

PERFORMANCE

Working in tandem, the Snapdragon 865 SoC, the LPDDR4X RAM and fast UFS 3.1 storage offer enough power to provide a smooth experience while using the phone. As we found out, be it multitasking, apps of daily use, or even heavy-duty games, the powerful hardware of the device is good for all day-to-day tasks. We did not notice any micro-stutters or lags while using the device and even playing demanding games, the device did not disappoint as it ran titles such as Call of Duty Mobile and Asphalt 9 Legends without any troubles.



Price
₹36,490

The S20 FE 5G clocked a high median FPS of 59 frames while playing Call of Duty Mobile. And when we switched focus to Asphalt 9 Legends, the phone performed even better as it managed to hit a median FPS of 60. Achieving such high median FPS at 100 per cent stability while playing graphics-intensive games is quite impressive as it's on par with the results of the Snapdragon 888 totting ROG Phone 5 and interestingly even better than the OnePlus 9.

However, the phone's not exactly a winner at other benchmarks, with the Galaxy S20 FE 5G only scoring 567076 points on AnTuTu and 861 points in the single-core and 2809 points in the multi-core test of Geekbench. 3D Mark Wild Life results again aren't anything to write home about as the phone only scored 3772 points – a tally significantly lower than that of the OnePlus 9.

CAMERAS

The Galaxy S20 FE 5G offers the same set-up – and the same performance – offered by the 4G variant of the Galaxy S20 FE. The phone's camera app also brings access to Samsung's computa-

tional photography-based modes such as Single Take and Live Focus. The latter being the phone's portrait mode which clicks some really nice shots with good depth effect in them. The mode works almost equally well in both daytime and low light conditions. However, in the latter, the level of detail and accuracy of the blur along the edges of the subject goes for a toss a little. But apart from this, the low-light performance of the camera set-up is generally good.

BATTERY

The phone comes with a big 4500 mAh battery pack which manages to last over a day on moderate use. The fact that the phone only comes with a 15 W charger in the box -- even though the phone supports up to 25 W fast charging -- is a definite red-flag. During our review of the device, the bundled charger took a little over an hour and a half to fill the phone's battery completely. In comparison, the OnePlus 9 takes around 50 minutes to charge to the brim using the bundled charger.

VERDICT

Yet, despite being a mixed bag in the battery department, it's the overall performance of the Galaxy S20 FE 5G that makes it a worthwhile investment. At ₹47,999, it is one of the best – if not the best – smartphones available in the sub ₹50,000 segment of the market right now.

–Sushant Talwar

SPECIFICATIONS

WEIGHT: 190 g | DISPLAY TYPE: Super AMOLED, 120 Hz | DISPLAY SIZE: 6.5-inches | RESOLUTION: 1080 x 2400 pixels | OS: Android 10, One UI 3.1 | CHIPSET: Qualcomm SM8250 Snapdragon 865 5G | GPU: Adreno 650 | STORAGE: 128 GB, 6 GB RAM | 128 GB, 8 GB RAM | 256 GB, 8 GB RAM | MAIN CAMERA: 12 MP, 8 MP, 12 MP | SELFIE CAMERA: 32 MP | FINGERPRINT SENSOR TYPE: Under display, Optical | BATTERY: Li-Ion 4500 mAh with fast charging up to 25 W

CONTACT

SAMSUNG INDIA | PHONE: 1 800-40-7267864 | EMAIL: Web Form | WEBSITE: www.samsung.com/in